

TRUE POTENTIAL

A peek into the future, and what we really should be heading towards

“Good morning class!” said Victoria out aloud. It was 10 PM on a Tuesday, but this was normal for her.

Humanity had used technology to lick a lot of the world's problems, but time wasn't conquered just yet. She immediately got 39 varied but quick replies, “Good morning Ms Shaw!” Time zones were tricky, and some of the kids were sleepy after just waking up, some were sleepy because it was nearing bedtime, and others were just annoyed because it was the middle of the day and they were too full of energy to be made to sit still – yet the world always adapted, and so would this little virtual primary classroom.

“Wait. 39? Who's missing?”, and as she thought that her Retina display told her that Arun was late, again. She sent out a quick ping, which sounded in little Arun's home, and this immediately brought Arun's mother running into her picture. “Sorry Ms Shaw, he'll be here in 30 seconds”, said Savita. “Thank you Mrs. Radia. We'll wait in that case” replied Victoria. There were giggles all around – young kids find everything funny.

Victoria heard a bustle and some incomprehensible yells and Arun soon appeared

in front of his iLearn station. “Sorry ma'am”, he said sheepishly, and there was even more giggling that promptly turned his face red.

Arun put on his skull cap – another Mapple rental, because kids out grew them so fast there was no point buying them one – and now everyone was ready.

“Today, class, we're going even further back in history, to look at some events that caused a radical change in technology”. This class was well behaved, but her TruSense app could sense the groans that the kids were dying to let out. “Now class, remember what we discussed. We cannot afford to ignore the past, because it holds the key to the future. Did anyone do any research on the subject?”

She got more feelings of despair from most, but little Arun sent out mixed emotions – a cross between embarrassment and enthusiasm. Thankfully she knew her little classroom as well as she knew herself. “Arun? Do you want to present something?” She knew his own tardiness and the class' giggles had made him unsure of himself, and wanted to encourage him to participate. Although most of the kids here were between 8 and 14 years old, Arun was only 5. It was normal for the

youngest and oldest kids to be picked on a little, because the younger you were the smarter you were thought to be, and obviously everyone else wanted to cut your ego down to size, whilst the older you were, the more the other kids looked at you as slow learner, and made fun of you.

“I'm not sure ma'am. I was working on something all of last night, but I don't think it's ready yet,” he said sheepishly. “Surely you can give all of us a taste of it, and if we feel it still needs work I'll cut the feed. Is that an acceptable compromise Arun?”

“Yes ma'am”

“OK class, please put on your Googles and sign in”

There was bustle all about, as invariably some of the kids always had untidy iLearns, and some components were always out of reach. Soon enough they were all hooked up and it took only microseconds for their Googles to quickly sync with their iLearn and activate their Retina displays. She eased her iLearn chair into Receive mode, hooked up her own Googles, set her TruSense to monitor mode and relaxed.

It was still marvellous technology for someone in her generation, but these kids always adapted so easily. Somehow

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